

HackRVA

The Mayor's Hackathon 2026

Dates: March 6th - March 8th, 2026

Location: CoStar Headquarters, Richmond, VA

Purpose:

To unite Richmond's most innovative tech minds to create impactful solutions for the city's future.

Schedule:

Friday and Saturday 9am-5pm

Saturday Evening: All solutions due

Sunday afternoon at CoStar: 10 finalists present 5-minute live pitches

Mayor Avula Announces Winners: Winner and runner-up for each category

Event Highlights:

· 7 Key Pillars provided by the Mayor's office

· 7 Data Sets for participants to utilize

· Teams collaborate to design actionable solutions addressing city priorities and initiatives

Competition:

· Winning Team receives the Mayor's Choice Award

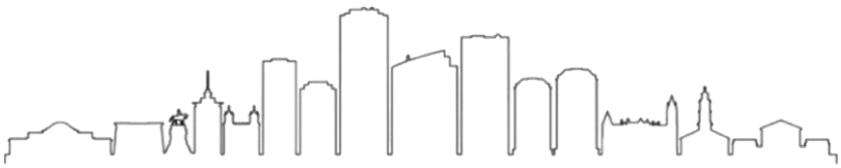
· Solution will be integrated into Richmond·s existing infrastructure

Prizes & Recognition:

· Mayor's Choice: Most useful solution for the city

· People's Choice: Most popular via live Google poll at the event

· Most Innovative: Most creative and groundbreaking approach



· Startup Material: Greatest potential for real-world startup

· Moonshot: Most ambitious and visionary solution

Logistics:

· This even is in collaboration with and powered by AI Ready RVA 501c3 and liability coverage

· Additional corporate sponsors TBD

Advisors and Planning Committee:

· Ford Prior, Michael Kolbe, Danny Avula, Nick Serfass, Alex Otanez, Ankit Mathur, Tom Becker, Crystal Harvey, Drew Cleveland, Claire Jordan

FAQ:

· Do I need to be a programmer to participate? Everyone is welcome. Programmers, designers, data analysts, policy experts, community organizers, anyone who cares about Richmond!

· Cost? This HackRVA is a completely free event

· Do I need to attend all three days? No! Choose Friday OR Saturday to build (or both if you'd like), then join us Sunday for the public celebration and awards ceremony. The flexible format accommodates different schedules

· What if I don't have a team? You can register as a free agent and join another team. Teams can register as complete teams or incomplete teams and will be paired with free agents. Teams are typically 3-5 people with diverse skills

· When does registration open? January 2026!